

is available for x86 64. The “64” means that the installer is for a 64-bit processor. The major distributions we have covered—Fedora, SuSE, Mandriva, Ubuntu, Knoppix, Gentoo—all have 64-bit versions.

8.3 Linux On A PowerPC?

Linux can be comfortably run on an Apple Mac, too. The scalability of Linux means that it can be used on Macs that are too old for OS X but still offer most of the nice features of the Mac OS. Linux for PowerPC (the processor used by Apple Macs before they switched to Intel), including the 64-bit version called the G5, is available from all major distributors. Most of the distributors that we have covered also have a PowerPC version—look for a version of their Linux for PPC or PowerPC on their site.

Many companies have found that they are able to make better use of older Mac models such as the RS/6000 or pSeries by running Linux on them and having more current hardware. Linux and PPC make for a good combination, given Linux’s stability and inherent server features. The Mac can support multiple processors and very large memory as compared to the Intel architecture.

Of particular mention here is Yellow Dog Linux, which is specifically made to be run on the PowerPC platform. Yellow Dog dual-boots with Mac OS as well. It includes The GIMP, Kontour (a vector graphics application), and OpenOffice.org; developers have C/C++, PHP, Pearl, and more. Yellow Dog uses the KDE desktop.

Tip

Downloading one CD’s ISO can be a daunting task in India, where internet speeds and download limitations are problems for large downloads. Downloading four or five CDs only makes life tougher. Instead, you can order it from www.kiraninfotech.com or www.buylinuxdvd.com.

These are Indian dealers from whom you can obtain Linux CDs and DVDs at reasonable costs. The Knoppix CD, for example, costs just Rs 50, while the DVD can be bought for just Rs 170.